

SPECIAL NEEDS PLANS: KNOW THE SNP

D-SNP, C-SNP and I-SNP | Federal definitions plus Aetna call-handling reminders | Verified through July 24, 2026

SNP = Medicare Advantage coordinated care plan designed for a defined eligible population. The acronym identifies the population - **not a guaranteed benefit package**.

D-SNP DUAL ELIGIBLE SNP	C-SNP CHRONIC CONDITION SNP	I-SNP INSTITUTIONAL SNP
WHO Medicare-eligible people who also receive Medicaid assistance under a state Medicaid plan.	WHO Medicare-eligible people with one or more qualifying severe or disabling chronic conditions approved for that plan.	WHO Medicare-eligible people who are institutionalized or institutionalized-equivalent. Federal rules include facility and community level-of-care pathways.
CORE IDEA Coordinates Medicare and Medicaid services. It may cover Medicaid services such as LTSS or behavioral health, depending on the state contract and plan.	CORE IDEA Enrollment and care design are targeted to the plan's qualifying condition population. Aetna may require provider verification of the condition.	CORE IDEA Institutionalized generally means 90+ days in a qualifying long-term-care setting. Subtypes: FI-SNP (facility), IE-SNP (community institutional LOC), HI-SNP (both).
VERIFY Medicaid status/category; state and plan; integration level; Medicaid MCO; which program/entity owns the requested service; current handbook/EOC.	VERIFY Exact qualifying condition; provider verification/attestation workflow; service area; plan availability; current plan documents.	VERIFY Qualifying setting or institutional level of care; expected duration; subtype; service area; current plan documents.
MEMBER-FRIENDLY "Your plan coordinates Medicare and Medicaid. The exact services handled by the plan depend on your state and specific plan."	MEMBER-FRIENDLY "This plan is designed around a qualifying chronic condition and includes condition-focused care support."	MEMBER-FRIENDLY "This plan is designed for people in long-term care or people living in the community who need an institutional level of care."
DO NOT ASSUME All benefits are \$0; every Medicaid service is administered by Aetna; every D-SNP is FIDE or HIDE.	DO NOT ASSUME Any chronic diagnosis qualifies; the same conditions or benefits apply to every C-SNP; eligibility is confirmed from the caller's statement alone.	DO NOT ASSUME I-SNP always means nursing home only; residence alone establishes eligibility; every facility participates.

LIVE-CALL FLOW: IDENTIFY > VERIFY > OPEN CURRENT PLAN SOURCE > EXPLAIN > DOCUMENT

1. Confirm plan ID, state and SNP type. **2.** Verify the eligibility fact that defines the SNP. **3.** Use the current member handbook, EOC, Summary of Benefits and internal desktop. **4.** State only confirmed benefits, limits and next steps.

RED FLAG: Do not quote benefits from the acronym, a generic webpage or an older training script. The photographed Aetna COE script directs representatives to use the most current plan-specific member handbook.

Primary authorities: 42 CFR 422.2; CMS Special Needs Plans and C-SNP guidance; Aetna Medicare SNP, D-SNP, C-SNP and I-SNP pages current in 2026. **Status:** Peer-created quick reference; not Aetna-approved; current plan documents and controlled internal procedures govern.